

Econ/Civics

U.S.





About the Course

This covers a variety of citizenship topics. Students spend the first term reflecting on the value of thinking for the Christian life or on building helpful habits. The second term focuses on government as students explore the historical documents and decisions from this rotation. The year finishes with a term of economics where students learn a variety of economic theories.

This topic is included in the following course(s): Citizenship: Grade 10 (U.S.)



Placement & Combining Tips

Lessons are occasionally integrated with composition lessons. Term 2 Government lessons are shared with Grades 9 and 11.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
10	Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) 1 time/week 40 min	Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God Atomic Habits What Would Keynes Do? Reading PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Citizenship: Grade 10 (U.S.)				
Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.)	Community Read Alouds: Grades 1-12 Current Events: Grades 9-12		Ethics: Part 4	



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.)



Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God



Atomic Habits



What Would Keynes Do?



Reading PDF



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

(No Quick Links Assigned)

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Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.)

How To Approach



Prepare

If you, the student, are learning at home, work to schedule a time with your teacher when you can complete the lessons from *Ourselves* or your Ethics reading together, as these lessons are much richer when shared and discussed.



Recap

Connect back to the previous lesson. (Optional for Current Events).



Introduce

For news sources: Scan the headlines first to get an overview, and then choose a story to read.



Read

Read the selection assigned or the news story chosen for the time assigned. For rich, dense, or more challenging books such as *Ourselves*, it is a good idea to read them aloud. Keep an eye out for quotes to put in your commonplace book or events or characters to put down in your *Book of Centuries*.



Narrate

Process and integrate your reading by narrating either orally or in writing. Some lesson plans will give you a suggestion of how best to narrate. To keep yourself on track, you might want to set a timer so you stop reading with enough time to narrate.



Connect

After your narration, think about how what you read connects to other subjects, other books, other things you've read or watched, or seen in the past or present. For current events, look up where events occurred on a map and ask questions together to discern the quality of the piece. (e.g., Are there sources cited? Is there an obvious bias? If so, what do other authors have to say on this subject? Are arguments supported by evidence? Is that evidence credible?) Consider reading an alternative perspective.



Citizenship Notebook

Record important ideas in your Citizenship Notebooks. Make a calendar of current events.



Teacher Note

These lessons are written directly to students, but to assist them throughout the year, please read through this section and the lesson plans so you are familiar with the instructions and flow of the lessons. You may also want to preview and choose which news sites to offer students.

Those educating at home might pick one lesson to read aloud (such as the Ethics readings on Cultural Engagement, Conscience, etc.) with their students to keep up the habit of oral narration and foster conversation and relationship and then simply give students these lesson plans and the rest of the books and check in with them throughout the term for conversation, support, and accountability.

It is valuable for those in a classroom setting to also have a mix of lessons, which students complete themselves silently, and others read aloud and narrated together. Classroom settings lend themselves well to additional discussion and sharing at the end of lessons, after everyone has narrated either together or independently in writing.

Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.)

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Term 1

WEEK 1 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 1

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ INTRO

The Gospel of Matthew records a conversation between Jesus and a lawyer. "Teacher, which is the great commandment in the Law?" Jesus replied, "You shall love the Lord your God with all your heart and with all your soul and with all your mind. This is the great and first commandment. And a second is like it: You shall love your neighbor as yourself. On these two commandments depend all the Law and the Prophets" (Matt. 22:36-40). This term, you will be challenged to cultivate the life of the mind in a way that results in obedience to the first and great commandment.

→ READ

Introduction

→ REFLECT/WRITE

Read and reflect on how Romans 11:36 and Colossians 1:15-17 relate to the reading in the book. Jot down your ideas or discuss with someone.

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 1

→ INTRO

Habits play a significant role in Charlotte Mason's philosophy of education. According to Mason, "Now, habits which are allowed to fall into disuse are all the same as though they had never been formed; powers not exercised grow feeble and are lost. The ground which has been gained in half-a-dozen years may be lost in a single one" (Mason, Vol. 5, p.251). Mason reminds us it is not only important to cultivate good habits, it is equally imperative to exercise those habits or else they will be lost.

This term you will be led through several exercises to teach you how to identify and implement habits that result in life transformation. Some of these exercises include how to maintain the practice of habit-keeping so you do not lose momentum. You will refer to your journal or notebook several times during the term to complete the assigned exercises.

→ READ

Introduction - Ch.1

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ REFLECT & WRITE

Before you begin, read the short article How to Mark a Book by Mortimer Adler. This will equip you with reading techniques to help you interact with the reading in a deeper and more meaningful manner. Pay attention to the assigned reading. A couple of chapters may not be assigned given the length of the book, but you are encouraged to complete the book when you have the opportunity.

∞ **Article Link:** How to Mark a Book by Mortimer Adler

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Term 1

Looking back at the chapter as needed, in your journal contrast goals and systems. Reflect on your life practices to see if you can identify systems that are at work in your life currently. Jot those down.

WEEK 2 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 2

- Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; A Journal or Notebook; a Bible
- Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.1

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ WRITE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, write about the relationship between thinking, feeling, and doing in your journal.

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 2

→ READ

Ch.2-3

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ WRITE

In your journal make a list of your habits, both positive and negative, that shape your identity. Describe the Habit Loop in your own words.

→ REFLECT

Read 2 Corinthians 5:17-21 and reflect on what the Bible teaches regarding a person's identity. Jot down any thoughts.

WEEK 3 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 3

- Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; A Journal or Notebook; a Bible
- Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.2

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ CONCEPT MAP



Term 1

Have you considered how a person can have a friendship with an author that he or she has never met? Reflect on the author who has had the greatest impact on your life. In your journal, make a concept map that highlights some of the things that you learned from the author.

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 3

→ READ

Ch.4-5

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ EXERCISE

In your journal use the "Habits Scorecard" on p.64-65 to think through the impact your habits may be having on your daily living.

→ DEFINE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, define the 1st Law of Behavior Change, and describe "Habit Stacking."

→ REFLECT

Reflect on the habits that you identified last week. What criteria do you use to determine if a habit is good, bad, or neutral? How does the Bible address any of the habits you identified? Jot down your thoughts.

WEEK 4 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 4

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.3

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ LIST

In your journal, make a list of the questions that you have concerning God, the Bible, the local church, theology, etc., and commit to tracking down answers to these questions during the next few terms.

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 4

→ READ

Ch.6-7

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.



Term 1

→ REFLECT

Consider the role self-control plays when trying to maintain good habits or break bad habits. Read Galatians 5:16-26 and reflect on the fruit of the Spirit and jot down any thoughts of how these verses apply to habits.

→ EXERCISE

Review your list of habits in your journal. Identify a new habit you want to incorporate into your life. Follow the template on p.96 to start developing a system for that new habit. If time permits, you can review the template on p.97 to make progress towards breaking a bad habit.

WEEK 5 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 5

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.4

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ BULLET POINT

In your journal, identify ideas that you devote a significant amount of mental energy towards. Reflect on whether these ideas are leading you closer to Christ or are distracting you from loving God with your mind.

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 5

→ READ

Ch.8-9

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ DEFINE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, define the 2nd Law of Behavior Change. Explain the role culture and family members play in habit formation. Contrast Romans 12:1-8 with what you wrote.

→ REFLECT

Think about what has motivated you in the past to establish and maintain habits. What has caused you to lose interest in some habits, while maintaining others? Reflect on how you have been influenced by culture and family members.



Term 1

WEEK 6 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 6

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.5

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ WRITE

Write a short letter that shares the gospel with a family member or friend.

→ REFLECT

Reflect on Colossians 1:28-29

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 6

→ READ

Ch.10-11

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ EXERCISE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, follow the template on p.136. You started this exercise during week 4 when you focused on the 1st Law. Now you will be focusing on the 2nd Law.

WEEK 7 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 7

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.6

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ DEFINE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, in your journal, define what it means to love God with your heart, soul, and mind.

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 7



Term 1

→ READ

Ch.12-13

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ DESCRIBE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, describe the role "friction" plays in establishing or breaking habits.

→ DEFINE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, define the 3rd Law of Least Effort and explain the "Two-Minute Rule."

WEEK 8 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 8

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.7

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ EXPLAIN

Looking back at the chapter as needed, explain how relativistic thinking can be both positive and negative.

 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 8

→ READ

Ch.14-15

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ REFLECT

Reflect on the "Cardinal Rule of Behavior Change." Jot down any thoughts.

→ EXERCISE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, follow the template on p.178 and focus on the 3rd Law of creating good habits. This is a continuation of the exercise you were working on during week 4 and week 6.



Term 1

WEEK 9 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 9

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.8

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ LIST

Looking back at the chapter as needed, in your journal, list reasons why "relativism" is not compatible with God's creation. Include several Scripture references.

40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 9

→ READ

Ch.16-17

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ REFLECT

Reflect on the benefits of habit tracking and accountability. Jot down your thoughts.

→ EXERCISE

Looking back at the chapter as needed, follow the template on p.212 and focus on the 4th Law of creating good habits. This is a continuation of the exercise you were working on during weeks 4, 6, and 8.

WEEK 10 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 10

Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.9

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ REFLECT

Reflect on the various spheres of life (home, church, community, sports team, etc.) that you inhabit.



Term 1

→ CONCEPT MAP

Use a concept map to illustrate the various spheres of life you inhabit and list the ideas/topics of intellectual stimulation that each sphere provides. Identify which sphere provides the greatest intellectual stimulation.

☐ 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 10

→ READ

Ch.18-19

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ CONCEPT MAP

Use a concept map to explain the "Big Five."

→ DEFINE

Define the "Goldilocks Rule," and then examine the habits that you desire to establish in light of the "Goldilocks Rule."

WEEK 11 ☐ 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 11

☐ Materials: Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

☐ Materials: Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones; a Journal or Notebook; a Bible

→ READ

Ch.12

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ REFLECT

Reflect on the section from this chapter that challenged you the most.

→ PRAY

Allow what you reflected on to guide your time in prayer.

☐ 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 11

→ READ

Ch.20-Conclusion

→ NARRATE

Take a moment to narrate silently or aloud the main ideas of the reading.

→ WRITE

In your journal, explain the importance of reflection and reviewing of established habits.

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Term 1

WEEK 12 ☐ 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God

☐ Econ/Civics: Grade 10 - Lesson 12

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Atomic Habits: An Easy & Proven Way to Build Good Habits & Break Bad Ones

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Term 2	
WEEK 1	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 13
WEEK 2	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 14
WEEK 3	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 15
WEEK 4	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 16
WEEK 5	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 17
WEEK 6	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 18
WEEK 7	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 19
WEEK 8	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 20
WEEK 9	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 21
WEEK 10	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 22
WEEK 11	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 23
WEEK 12	40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 24

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Term 3

WEEK 1 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 25

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ INTRO

Do an inspection review of this book. (Remember: Read the info on the back and front and skim a few random pages, etc.) Notice particularly the names under the Question headings. You will find there are some names that recur often. In each lesson, you will encounter several economists and their approaches/positions on the issue; focus on the theory and the positions.

→ READ

p.6-7, 10-13

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss the theory of free market economics (p.11) and the reality of "trade-offs". What did you learn about externalities?

If you are doing these lessons independently with no one to discuss them with, write down your thoughts.

TEACHER TIP:

Discussion of these lessons is very beneficial for the understanding of Economics.

WEEK 2 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 26

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.14-18 & 19-22

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- What is utilitarianism (p.15), and what is the rational choice theory (p.17)?
- What did you learn about the principle of marginal utility? How is that applied in a Neoclassical theory?

WEEK 3 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 27

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.23-26 & 28-31

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss the mutually beneficial agreements/Pareto efficiency (p.24).
- Write about how relative prospects play in behavioral theory. Include the text example and give an example of your own.

WEEK 4 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 28

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.32-35 & 36-39

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Term 3

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss the section on recycling (p.36) and the different views related to external cost and social benefit. What makes the most sense to you and why?

WEEK 5 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 29

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.40-43 & 44-47

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss the economic theory of costs, benefits, and incentives (p.42).
- In what ways do incentives impact your decisions?

WEEK 6 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 30

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.50-53

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss how the principle of diminishing returns impacts the principle of utility (p.51).
- Explain, "Marginal utility theory states that we will maximize our welfare by consuming a quantity of goods that enables us to gain the most satisfaction given our limited budget."

WEEK 7 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 31

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.54-57

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss adverse selection and Gresham's Law (p.55).
- Discuss information asymmetry.

WEEK 8 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 32

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.58-62 & 63-66

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- What is spontaneous cooperation? How do you explain it from competing worldviews (viz., secular vs. Christian)?
- Tell what you know about price theory (p.63).

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Term 3

WEEK 9 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 33

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.67-70 & 71-75

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss the idea of moral hazard in giving aid to others (p.68).
- What is the point of gift-giving? How does a Christian worldview impact our perspective?

WEEK 10 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 34

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.76-79

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss the impact of restrictions (tariffs and quotas) on economic trade (p.76).
- Discuss the differing perspectives on "buying local".

WEEK 11 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 35

Materials: What Would Keynes Do?, notebook

→ READ

p.80-83

→ DISCUSS AND/OR WRITE

- Discuss behavioral economics (p.83).
- Discuss default options and choice aversion. Have you seen this happen with either yourself or friends/family?

WEEK 12 40m Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.) - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

What Would Keynes Do?

Econ/Civics: Grade 10 (U.S.)

Examination

Term 1

· Think: The Life of the Mind and the Love of God: Choose one question to answer:

Write about four things you learned from the book.

or

Explain why anti-intellectualism is not compatible with Christianity.

· Atomic Habits: Define the Four Laws of Behavior Change presented in the book.

Term 3

· What Would Keynes Do?: Choose one question or quote and explain in light of the economic principles you have learned, giving examples from everyday life around you:

- Explain rational choice theory and its impact on decision-making in a person's life.

- In What Would Keynes Do?, the author quotes Steven Levitt, "Economists love incentives. The typical economist believes the world has not yet invented a problem that he cannot fix if given a free hand to design the proper incentives schemes."

- How do we best manage common resources?

- "We give to charity in order to better provide public goods not supplied by the market."